

SARAH BLANCH

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Office Management · Administration & Accounts · Client Service

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Office manager with eight years running the day-to-day operations of a 45-suite serviced office centre in Newcastle CBD - front of house and reception, client service, accounts and payroll administration in Xero, BAS data preparation for external accountants, staff recruitment and onboarding, supplier and maintenance coordination, and reporting directly to the director. Held this scope as Office Administrator from 2018 and was appointed Office Manager in 2025. Highly organised and detail-focused, proficient in Microsoft Word, Excel and Outlook, and accustomed to working independently and prioritising a varied workload. Experienced in handling confidential financial, legal and medical information for professional-services clients, including accounting practices. I also build and automate the systems I run - templates, SOPs, CRM and payment workflows - so the office runs smoothly with less manual effort.

KEY SKILLS

- Office & front-of-house management
- Invoicing & reconciliation (Xero)
- Supplier & maintenance management
- Reception, phones & visitor service
- Payroll & BAS data preparation
- Microsoft Word, Excel & Outlook
- Administration, data entry & records
- HR admin, recruitment & onboarding
- Customer service focus
- Meetings, appointments & scheduling
- Policies, SOPs & compliance
- Confidentiality & discretion

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Office Manager (Business Operations) | Newcastle City Business Centre, Newcastle NSW 2025 – Sep 2026

Office Administrator | Newcastle City Business Centre - promoted to Office Manager Aug 2018 – 2025

Sole operational lead of a heritage serviced-office centre - 45 private suites plus 3 casual rooms across five office levels of a seven-level building, serving legal, psychology, allied health, accounting, consulting and technology clients. The responsibilities below were carried across both roles.

- Ran front of house and reception for a busy multi-tenant centre - greeting clients and visitors, **high-volume call handling**, virtual reception services, meeting-room bookings, and calendars and appointments for tenants and the director.
- Managed day-to-day office operations across a seven-level heritage building - supplies, cleaning and presentation standards, maintenance, trades and contractors (quotes, scheduling, tenant notices and completion follow-up) - escalating commercial and liability decisions to the director.
- Ran **accounts and payroll administration in Xero**: payroll administration throughout, recurring and one-off invoicing, deposits and incentives, debtor follow-up, supplier records and reconciliation support; redesigned the payment architecture to introduce online and recurring payments.
- Prepared and handed over **BAS data to the external accountants** for NCBC and two other businesses owned by the director, including a New Zealand-based business, working to each entity's reporting deadlines.
- Recruited, onboarded, trained, rostered and supervised reception and cleaning staff, and was retained specifically to train managerial staff, earning a bonus for it - role descriptions, advertisements, interviews, induction checklists and performance feedback.
- Built the centre's administration framework - an **SOP and template library**, master operating calendar, recruitment packs and Google Apps Script tooling - keeping processes consistent, compliant and easy to hand over.
- Handled **confidential financial, legal and medical documentation** for tenants and their clients, applying privacy and consent procedures with legal, health and accounting practices.
- Owned the full client lifecycle - enquiries, inspections, proposals, licence agreements, onboarding, renewals and departures - and monitored conversion and retention risk.
- Produced the **monthly director's report** - occupancy, revenue, debtors, maintenance, staffing and risks - and rebuilt it as a largely AI-automated workflow from Xero exports, cutting preparation from 4 hours to 30 minutes.

- Lifted occupancy from approximately **75% in 2018 to full occupancy by 2023**, holding 85–100% through 2026, while growing the virtual office client base and lifting average client spend through tier upgrades and add-on services.
- Restructured pricing and packaging across all services - office tiers, virtual office, meeting rooms and administrative services - grounded in detailed market and competitor research; implemented the approved changes.
- Led brand and marketing, including NCBC's brand guidelines, the Squarespace website redevelopment and local SEO.
- Built and operated an **AI-powered market-intelligence briefing** for staff and the director (newcastle-flexspace-intelligence.sarahblanch.chatgpt.site), turning 26+ sources into weekly briefs and a monthly strategic verdict.

Business Operations, Marketing & Website Consultant | Self-employed (part-time) 2012 – Present

- Deliver end-to-end business management, marketing and website services for small businesses and sole traders.
- Manage clients' day-to-day business operations and lead planning and growth strategy - pricing, service planning and diversifying revenue streams.
- Advise small-business owners on brand identity, market positioning and cost-effective marketing, using analytics to guide strategic and budget decisions.
- Design and build client websites and CRM systems, and automate recurring administration including client management, scheduling and payment workflows.
- Support business setup and day-to-day operations - e.g. Studio Sovia (studiosovia.com.au), an interior design studio launched with its website, enquiry pipeline and operating structure in place.
- Assist clients to meet tax and regulatory requirements - record-keeping, income reporting and compliance obligations.

Earlier roles include Administration & Sales Assistant, WineArt Gallery (2016–2018) - payments, supplier liaison and financial records; and Restaurant Manager, Das Hund Haus (2014–2016) - payroll, budgeting, banking and staff rostering. Details on request.

TECHNOLOGY & SYSTEMS

Productivity & communication: Microsoft 365 (Word, Excel, Outlook) · Google Workspace (Sheets, Forms) · Zoom & Microsoft Teams · Calendly-style scheduling · task & project management tools

Business & finance: Xero (invoicing, payroll, reconciliation) · BAS data preparation for accountants · Stripe · PayPal · Square · subscription & recurring-billing platforms

CRM & automation: CRM design, build & implementation (incl. Zoho) · advanced AI workflow design & automation (ChatGPT, Claude, agentic tools) · Python & TypeScript scripting · Google Apps Script

Web & content: Squarespace · WordPress · Wix · HTML/CSS · Canva · Adobe Photoshop & Lightroom · photography & content creation

Marketing & analytics: Meta Business Suite · Mailchimp · Google Analytics · Google Business Profile & local SEO · listing & booking platforms

EDUCATION & QUALIFICATIONS

Certificate III in Administration - Newcastle TAFE - 2018

Certificate II in Business - Newcastle TAFE - 2012

Higher School Certificate - Merewether High School - 2011

REFEREES

Available on request.